TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Describe How Your Work or Company Has Changed

Narrate | PPF | Timeline Reconstruction

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Tell how something at work has changed: how it was before, how it is now and what is better, what comes next, and what is still open.

WHO You have worked in the office for five years. Kumar, from sales, worked in Singapore for two years and has just come back to his old job.

SITUATION It is Kumar's first week. He wants to take leave next month and asks you: "Do I still fill in the paper form?" In March last year, the office moved leave from paper forms to the HR app.

NEED Kumar needs the change in order: how it was before, how it is now and what is better, what changes in January, and what is still not sorted.

GOAL Tell the change in order (Past → Present → Future) with one clear difference, and say what is still open.

Before (until March last year)

- Paper form, handed in one week before
- Mr. Tan signed it: about three days
- Forms sometimes went missing

Now and next (the HR app)

- Apply at least two days before
- Answer usually the same day · no lost forms so far
- MC: paper to Siti now; from January, a photo in the app
- Still open: two part-time staff can't log in yet

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: “I want to take leave next month. Do I still fill in the paper form, like before?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Until March last year, everyone in this office used to fill in a paper leave form. We handed it in a week before and waited about three days for Mr. Tan to sign it. Now we apply in the HR app at least two days before, and Mr. Tan answers on his phone, usually the same day. So far, we haven’t lost a single form. From January, we’re going to send our MCs in the app too. We’ll just take a photo, so nobody needs to bring the paper MC to my desk. One thing is still open: our two part-time staff have no company email, so they can’t log in yet. For now, I still take their paper forms.

P PAST · HOW IT WAS BEFORE

P PRESENT · HOW IT IS NOW

F FUTURE · WHAT COMES NEXT

! STILL OPEN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali tells a new staff member how IT help has changed: before → now → next → still open.

- [ ] One thing is still open: printer problems still come by phone, so I need a way to record them.
- [ ] Now everyone sends a request in the help form. So far, I've answered every request within two days.
- [ ] Two years ago, when a computer broke, people came to my desk or called me, and I often forgot the small jobs.
- [ ] Next month, I'm going to add a page with answers to the five most common problems.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · how it was before · **P** = Present · how it is now · **F** = Future · what comes next · **!** = Still open

---

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

PAST · HOW IT WAS BEFORE

- [ ] Until last year, we …
- [ ] Before, we used to …
- [ ] In the past, everyone had to …
- [ ] When I started here, …

PRESENT · HOW IT IS NOW

- [ ] Now we …
- [ ] These days, …
- [ ] So far, we have …
- [ ] It's much faster now, because …

FUTURE · WHAT COMES NEXT

- [ ] From January, we're going to …
- [ ] Next month, …
- [ ] Soon, you'll be able to …

STILL OPEN

- [ ] One thing is still open: …
- [ ] For now, we still …
- [ ] The only problem now is …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Until March last year, we filled in paper forms. [For example, / Because / Now] we use the HR app.

2. Mr. Tan answers on his phone. [so / although / but] we usually get an answer the same day.

3. The app is much faster. [but / for example, / because] our two part-time staff can't use it yet.

4. You take a photo of your MC. [because / but / First … then …] you send it in the app.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Before the app, we _____ fill in a paper form. (A habit in the past that has stopped)
   ○ used to ○ using to ○ use to

2. These days, Mr. Tan _____ leave requests on his phone. (How it is today)
   ○ answering ○ answer ○ answers

3. So far, we _____ any forms. (Up to now, no exact time)
   ○ haven't lose ○ don't lost ○ haven't lost

4. From January, we _____ send our MCs in the app. (A plan)
   ○ are going to ○ going ○ are go to

SLIDE 09 Before and now: used to · so far

For how things were before, use used to + verb (or Past Simple). For how things are now, use Present Simple. For the difference up to now, use so far + have / has + past participle.

Before, we **used to fill in** a paper form.

Mr. Tan **used to sign** every form. Now he **answers** on his phone.

These days, everyone **applies** in the app.

So far, we **haven't lost** a single form.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

PAST · BEFORE

Until …, we used to …

P

PRESENT · NOW

Now we … So far, we have …

F

FUTURE · NEXT

From …, we're going to …

!

STILL OPEN

One thing is still open: …

SLIDE 11

Timeline Reconstruction

The speaker tells how something changed, from a mixed-up card. The listener cannot see the card: they write the note (before → now → what is better → next), numbered in the order heard, read it back and ask two questions.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: your card is mixed up. Tell it in order: before → now → what is better → next.
2. Listener: no card. Fill in the note and number the lines 1–4 as you hear them. Read it back, then ask two questions.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same change to a new listener, shorter. Listeners use the next column.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: speakers turn the workbook over, listeners write. Then swap roles: rounds 1–3 again.

Card 1 · Customer orders

Card 2 · Clocking in

Card 3 · Deliveries

Card 4 · Weekly team meeting

Listener's note: what changed

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Before (until when?)			
Now			
What is better			
Next / still open			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Kumar asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Why did the office stop using the paper forms?**
2. **If I'm sick next week, where do I send my MC?**
3. **When will the part-time staff get the app?**

Start with: **Because …** · **Until January, you …** · **I'm not sure. I'll ask Siti and tell you by …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend who moved to KL ten years ago is back in JB for the holidays and asks how your area has changed. Tell them how it was before, how it is now, and what is coming next. No idea? Use this: ten years ago, one row of shops and a quiet road; now a big mall and a traffic jam at 6 p.m.; next year, a new flyover.

When you lived here, we used to … · **Now there's …** · **So far, …** · **Next year, they're going to …**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says how things were before, when it changed, and how they are now, in that order.
- [ ] Names one difference the change made, with a number or an example.
- [ ] Says what comes next and one thing that is still open.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Before → now, in order	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
One clear difference	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Next and still open	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Customer orders

You are Kumar, back after two years in Singapore. Fill in the note: before, now, what is better, next / still open. Then ask: A customer wants to order today. What do I tell her?

Card 2 · Clocking in

You are Mei Ling, back from three months' maternity leave. Fill in the note: before, now, what is better, next / still open. Then ask: What do I do on my first morning?

Card 3 · Deliveries

You are Ali. You are making slides for a customer visit. Fill in the note: before, now, what is better, next / still open. Then ask: Can I put a number on my slide?

Card 4 · Weekly team meeting

You are Siti. You are writing the new staff handbook. Fill in the note: before, now, what is better, next / still open. Then ask: What should a new person know on day one?

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Customer orders

Next month: e-wallet payment in the chat · Now: customers order from our chat catalogue · Until last June: phone orders, written in a notebook · So far: wrong orders down from 20 a month to 5 · Open: older customers still phone

Card 2 · Clocking in

Open: a queue at the machine at 8.55 a.m. · Until two months ago: a punch card at the door · Next month: see your own hours in the HR app · Now: a face-scan machine at the door · So far: no lost cards, no counting by hand

Card 3 · Deliveries

So far: no late parcels; KL and Penang in 2 days · Now: Fast Go collects our parcels at 4 p.m. daily · Next year: send to Singapore too · Until January: our own van, one driver, JB only · Open: big boxes cost more, no price yet

Card 4 · Weekly team meeting

Now: online, Monday 9 a.m., 20 minutes · Open: sales staff are often with customers at 9 · Until last year: in the meeting room, about 1 hour · Next month: also meet face to face once a month · So far: no meeting over 20 minutes